Unit – 1 Introduction

Evolution of Film-Making

Introduction

Film-making means creating stories using moving pictures, sound, and editing. It includes shooting videos with cameras, recording audio, cutting scenes, adding music, and showing the final film to the audience.

Film-making has changed greatly over time. At first, films were silent and black-and-white. Later, sound and color were added. Today, films are made digitally using computers and editing software.

The major stages in the evolution of film-making are:

1. Silent film era
2. Development of editing
3. Introduction of sound
4. Color cinema
5. New Wave movements
6. Digital revolution

Each stage brought new technology and better storytelling methods.

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1. Silent Film Era (1890s–1920s)

The earliest films were called **silent films**.

Characteristics

- No recorded dialogue
- No sound effects
- Live music was played in theatres
- Films were black and white
- Actors used strong facial expressions and body movements
- Text cards were used to show dialogue

Editing Style

- Scenes were joined simply

- Few cuts were used
- Stories depended mainly on visuals

This era was important because it created the basic rules of camera use and storytelling in films.

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2. Development of Film Editing

As films became longer, filmmakers understood that **editing** was very important.

Editing means arranging shots in a proper order to tell the story clearly.

Important Changes

- Shots from different places were cut together
- Events happening at the same time were shown using cross-cutting
- This made films more exciting

Editing helped create suspense and smooth storytelling.

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3. The Kuleshov Effect

The **Kuleshov Effect** proved that the meaning of a shot changes based on the shot placed next to it.

Explanation

- The same face can appear sad, hungry, or happy
- This depends on the image shown before or after it
- Viewers connect the two shots in their mind

Importance

- Editors can control emotions
- Meaning comes from sequence, not just one image
- Editing became a psychological tool

This discovery showed that editing is very powerful.

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4. Introduction of Sound in Cinema

In the late 1920s, sound was added to films.

Changes Brought by Sound

- Actors started speaking on screen

- Music and sound effects were recorded
- Dialogue became part of storytelling
- Editing had to match sound with picture

This change made films more realistic and emotional.

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5. Color Cinema and Studio System

After sound, color was introduced in movies.

Features

- Bright and natural colors
- Better lighting and costumes
- More visual beauty

Effects

- Films became more attractive
- Fantasy and musical films increased
- Big studios produced many films

Color improved mood and made cinema more entertaining.

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6. New Wave Movements

During the 1950s and 1960s, filmmakers tried new styles.

Characteristics

- Shooting in real locations
- Hand-held cameras
- Simple sets
- New editing styles
- Personal stories

These movements gave directors more freedom and creativity.

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7. Digital Revolution

From the 1990s onwards, film-making became digital.

Major Developments

- Digital cameras replaced film reels
- Editing done on computers
- Non-linear editing systems used
- Special effects improved

Advantages

- Easy to correct mistakes
- No damage to original footage
- Faster production
- Low cost
- Worldwide online release

Digital technology made film-making available to many people.

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8. CGI and Online Platforms

CGI (Computer-Generated Imagery)

- Used to create unreal scenes
- Fantasy worlds and creatures
- Space and disaster scenes

Streaming Services

- Films released online
- Audience watch from home
- Global reach

These changed how people watch films.

2. Linear vs Non-Linear Editing

Introduction

Video editing is the process of selecting useful shots, removing unwanted parts, arranging scenes in proper order, adding sound and transitions, and preparing the final video for viewing. Editing plays a very important role in storytelling because it controls pace, continuity, and emotion.

In video production, two major editing systems are used:

1. **Linear Editing** - Linear editing was used in the early days of television and film production
2. **Non-Linear Editing (NLE)** - non-linear editing is widely used today because of digital technology.

Linear Editing

Meaning

Linear editing is the traditional method of editing video using magnetic tapes. In this system, scenes are copied from one tape to another in a straight sequence from beginning to end. Once a scene is recorded, changing it later is difficult because all the following scenes must be edited again.

This method is also called **tape-to-tape editing**.

Working Procedure

Steps:

1. The recorded tape is placed in the **source deck** (player).
2. A blank tape is placed in the **record deck**.
3. The editor plays the source tape.
4. Required scenes are selected using the controller.
5. Selected portions are copied onto the record tape.
6. The first scene is recorded, then the second, then the third — in strict order.
7. If a mistake occurs in the middle, all scenes after it must be re-edited.
8. This process continues until the complete programme is formed.

Advantages

- Simple technology.
- Easy to understand for beginners.
- Useful in early television studios.
- Does not require computers.
- Suitable for live or quick rough assembly in old systems.

Disadvantages,

- **Very slow process.**
- **Changes in the middle are difficult.**
- **No undo option.**
- **Quality reduces after repeated copying.**
- **Bulky equipment.**
- **Less creative freedom.**
- **Not suitable for complex projects today.**

Non-Linear Editing (NLE)

Meaning

Non-linear editing is the modern computer-based method of editing video. In this system, all video clips are stored as digital files on a computer. The editor can place scenes in any order and make changes at any time without damaging the original footage.

It is called **non-linear** because editing does not follow a fixed straight sequence.

Working Procedure

Steps:

1. Video footage is captured or transferred to a computer.
2. All clips are stored as digital files on hard disk or cloud.
3. The editor opens editing software.
4. Clips appear inside media bins or libraries.
5. Required clips are dragged onto the timeline.
6. Scenes can be cut, moved, deleted, or rearranged freely.
7. Effects, transitions, titles, and music are added.
8. Colour correction and sound mixing are done.
9. The final edited video is exported into the required format.

Advantages

- Highly flexible.
- Scenes can be inserted anywhere.
- Unlimited undo options.
- Fast editing.
- No quality loss while rearranging clips.
- Original footage remains safe.
- Supports HD and 4K videos.
- Professional tools available.
- Easy online distribution.

Disadvantages

- Requires powerful computers.
- Professional software may be expensive.
- Needs large storage space.
- Beginners require training.
- System crashes may cause data loss if backups are not taken.